

IAN HENRY

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PROFILE

Staff software engineer with 13 years of experience shipping consumer apps at Meta and Microsoft, from zero-to-one launches to products at scale.

HIGHLIGHTS

- Co-founded multiple greenfield initiatives at Meta, driving technical and organizational alignment from ideation to scale, reaching millions of users.
- Diverse and deep experience across many languages & frameworks: JavaScript, React, Python, C/C++, PHP/Hack.
- Skilled at parachuting into new tech stacks and large legacy codebases, delivering impact quickly.
- Brings a measurement-first approach: defines metrics, builds dashboards, and uses data to guide product decisions.
- Energized by cross-team collaboration, cultivating cohesive team culture rooted in technical craftsmanship, dedicating time to onboard, mentor and teach engineers across all seniority levels.

EXPERIENCE

Meta

August 2018 - April 2025

Instagram for Oculus – Staff Software Engineer

May 2024 - April 2025

- Early member of the team building a new Instagram app for Oculus VR, owning ambiguous and technically complex features end to end (JavaScript, React Native, GraphQL, Python):
 - Teen accounts: built quiet hours and daily limits, with extensive testing of complex business logic.
 - Content reporting: designed a novel architecture reusing code across platforms, cutting development and maintenance costs while meeting legal requirements.
 - Settings: embedded web settings into the native app, restyled to feel native, avoiding a costly rebuild.
 - Privacy work: delivered legally required features under strict deadlines, coordinating stakeholders across the org.
- UX design: drove design independently when designer bandwidth was limited, then partnered with the design team to iterate and implement final Figma specs pixel-perfect.
- Observability: instrumented core app functionality with dashboards and alerts, and scaled the practice across the team through best-practice docs, helper APIs, and tech talks.
- Leadership: led the core app surfaces team after launch, managing the roadmap, scoping work, partnering with PM and design, and mentoring junior engineers.

Messenger for iOS & Android – Staff Software Engineer

February 2024 - May 2024

- Tech lead: led a cross-org working group to improve media quality in the mobile apps, ramping up from zero on the Android codebase and diagramming every component affecting media quality (Java/Kotlin, C/C++, PHP/Hack).
- Strategy: aligned stakeholders across the org and wrote a state-of-media-quality document connecting user research to metrics gaps and dividing the work into owned workstreams with roadmaps.
- Measurement: began building image quality metrics, adding MS-SSIM scoring on the sender side and laying the groundwork for receiver-side scoring. The initiative was wound down in a re-org before launch.

Messenger for Desktop (Foundations) – Senior → Staff Software Engineer

January 2022 - February 2024

- Crash reliability: set the direction and goals, and cut the share of users experiencing crashes from 2% to 1% in six months by fixing the hardest JavaScript and C++ crashes and improving crash reporting. Led a 4-engineer workstream that improved tooling and fixed crashes, reducing it further to 0.6% on Windows and 0.4% on macOS.
- Performance: set the direction and goals for app performance and drove improvements across key flows, including a 20% cold-start reduction that increased daily active users by 1.2%. Performance tech lead for the end-to-end encrypted messaging launch, guiding and mentoring product engineers across teams to find and fix issues.

- Release process: defined and documented the release process (cadence, staged rollouts, on-call duties, regression thresholds), and caught metric regressions in beta before they reached production, sharing knowledge with on-call.
- Incident response: trusted go-to engineer for the most complex production incidents, resolving dozens of high-severity issues across JavaScript and C++ codebases, often under significant time pressure.
- Mentorship: onboarded and mentored engineers at all levels across the org through regular one-on-ones, detailed knowledge-sharing posts, and dozens of tech talks on crashes, performance, and releases.

Messenger for Desktop V2 – Senior Software Engineer

July 2020 - January 2022

- Launch parity lead: part of the team rebuilding Messenger Desktop from scratch in React Native; led 10+ engineers and data scientists across teams to find and fix engagement regressions in the rebuilt app, taking it to a 100% rollout. Ran daily war rooms and drove the hardest investigations myself, including finding the root cause of a major daily-active-user regression.
- Cross-stack engineering: one of few engineers working across JavaScript and C/C++, building some of the most complex features, such as rich deep linking from the web (via a local HTTP server) and local and push notifications. Also built a code generation engine that produced 171 APIs (about 30,000 lines) of JavaScript-to-C++ bindings, eliminating hand-written boilerplate.
- Infrastructure: owned telemetry, partnering with data science to keep metrics accurate, and developed build, release, and update infrastructure to support the launch.

Messenger for Desktop V1 – Software Engineer II → Senior Software Engineer

August 2018 - July 2020

- Launch: early team member building and shipping Messenger Desktop from scratch in Electron and React.
- Feature ownership: drove authentication (building a single sign-on framework with security engineering), the release process (fully automating Windows and Mac app store submissions), and auto-update (leading 4 engineers to get over 85% of users onto current versions).
- Migration lead: drove the migration of legacy Windows Store app users, growing daily active users from 1k to 600k.

Microsoft

August 2012 - August 2018

Web Services – Software Engineer II

August 2017 - August 2018

- Built, maintained, and monitored scalable web services for the Universal Store using C# and ASP.NET WebAPI.

App Developer – Software Engineer II

July 2015 - August 2017

- Mobile and desktop developer across a variety of first-party apps.
 - Podcast App: tech lead for brand new app; wrote the design doc, built core parts of the app using XAML and C#.
 - Groove Music App: implemented features using C#, C++/CX and XAML.
 - Office for iOS/Mac: built new features using Objective-C.

Operating Systems – Software Engineer II

August 2014 - June 2015

- Windows Phone mobile engineer, working in C++ and C# across Windows Phone OS codebase.

Engineering Systems – Software Engineer

August 2012 - April 2014

- Front-end web developer, building applications to manage build and test runs for the Windows Phone OS codebase using ASP.NET MVC, ASP.NET WebAPI, JavaScript, jQuery and CSS.

VOLUNTEERING

The Mountaineers

November 2025 - Present

- Implemented various website features and performance improvements requested by trip leaders and members; used AI tools (Cursor) to build with JavaScript & Python in a Plone & Zope based tech stack.

EDUCATION

Bachelor of Applied Science in Computer Engineering

2008 - 2012

University of British Columbia, Vancouver, Canada